



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PANAFRICAINNE DES ETUDIANTS
الاتحاد جميع الطلاب الأفريقي
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CAPACITY BUILDING
WORKING GROUP

GRAB-A-SKILL PROJECT



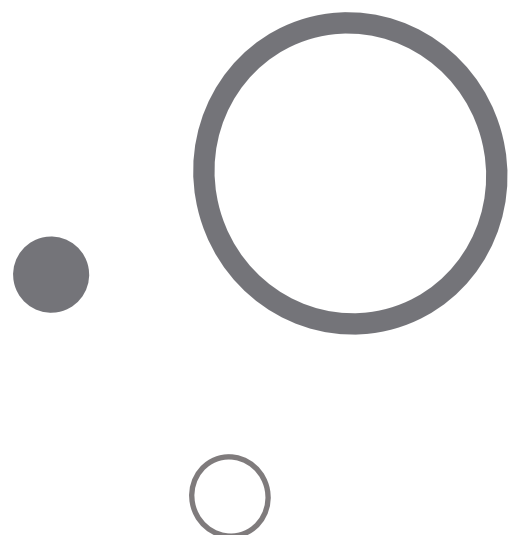
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1.0 BACKGROUND AND JUSTIFICATION

Many people especially the young and marginalized in society have little or no employable skills. In some cases, the skills they have do not match demand in the labour market. Preparing youth for the jobs of tomorrow remains a necessity in Africa, where many lack the digital knowledge and soft skills required to succeed.

Inadequate employable skills within the tertiary educational curricula and teaching programs are considered as serious barriers which seem to precipitate the observed patterns of unemployment and underemployment amongst university and college graduates in Africa. The need for additional employability skills-based curriculum in tertiary level educational programs accompanied by policies that address this gap is perceived as a potential solution, however, we believe that rejuvenation of the Technical and vocational education and training (TVET) system provides a better alternative to solve the fast-growing unemployment situation in Africa.

A Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET), with its focus on technology and science, practical skills, attitudes, and knowledge for specific occupations, could be the key to increasing youth employability. However, there is an underlying impression that TVET programs are not as valuable as traditional academic programs at universities. This general apathy towards TVET is held by most youths. This is due to the socio-cultural view of TVET being second fiddle to humanities and sciences. In fact, the worse performing students in basic schools [and dropouts] are those who are offered an opportunity to pursue TVET in secondary schools and Technical and Vocational Training Institutes. Efforts to rebrand TVET by successive governments have received lip service with no practical outcome, as national policy and resource allocation itself does not place TVET in the professed priority light. We, however, are of the view that programs that offer skills training to the youth have the power to both solve the continent's development challenges and generate new job opportunities for a youth population. With the right support, TVET institutions should be able to provide the right skills to the youth to start their own businesses and grow the business to employ large numbers. This is the rationale behind the GRAB A SKILL PROJECT, a project that offers entrepreneurial and employability skills to selected groups to empower them economically.



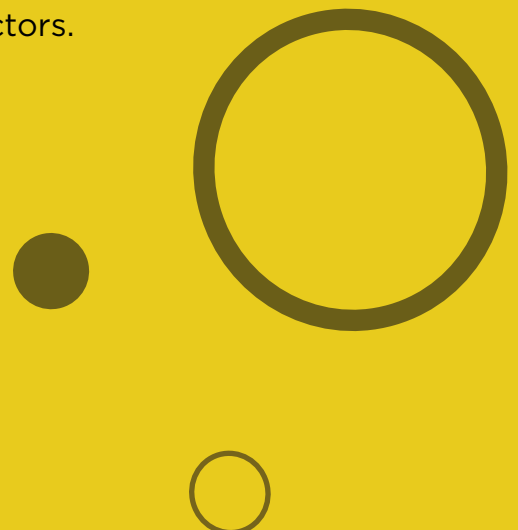
2.0 PROJECT OBJECTIVES

- Improve employment opportunities for continuing students and fresh graduates, vulnerable and marginalized groups through access to vocational skills training and enterprise development;
- Empower vulnerable groups especially females and disabled individuals to start or improve their businesses through the new skills acquired; the project will provide professional vocational skills to create employment opportunities for these vulnerable people;
- To provide entrepreneurship and life skills such as communication skills, team work and problem solving;
- To provide career guidance and counseling to young people to setup their business and/or join the labour market;
- Create an avenue for startup funders to sponsor the beneficiaries to start their businesses and benefit from mentorship and coaching to grow their businesses;
- To alleviate poverty and improve the standards of living for the youths of Africa.

3.0 PROJECT EXPECTED OUTCOMES

An anticipated outcome is that the project will equip youths with skills to create their own businesses, causing a ripple effect where these local businesses create jobs and expose more youth to digital skills relevant for today's digital economy.

The long-term outcome will be the reduction of national unemployment figures and the improvement in the growth of the national economy. The project will encourage the opening of business in both the service and product sectors.



4.0 PROJECT PHASES

Phases	Activity
Phase 1	This phase will be the knowledge transfer stage, where the beneficiaries will receive both classroom and field knowledge on their chosen skill areas. The student will receive 4 months of tuition on the methods and processes in their chosen fields.
Phase 2	This phase will be the stage where the beneficiaries will receive digital knowledge, marketing and promotion, leadership skills, etc. Here, the beneficiaries will receive lessons on coding, website designing, product promotion, etc. to complement the skills they gathered from the training
Phase 3	This stage is the pass out stage. At this stage, the beneficiaries will pass out from the project. The beneficiaries will be supported to establish themselves. The monitoring and evaluation will be communicated to them and schedules developed with them to keep track of their progress.



5.0 PROJECT DURATION

The project will last for 6 months, and be replicated after assessment are done to identify aspects for necessary improvements.

6.0 PROJECT BENEFICIARIES

- Students
- Unemployed youths
- Marginalized groups (Females, disabled persons, refugees and migrants)

7.0 FOCUS AREAS

The main areas that will be targeted are the vocational skill set area. These include

- Catering
- Dressmaking/Fashion
- Carpentry
- Electrical
- Cosmetology
- Handcraft production
- Bakery, etc

For this pilot stage, the focus will be on fashion designing and cosmetology for both males and females. For cosmetology the specific areas of focus are manicure, pedicure, hair treatment and hair styling/barbering.

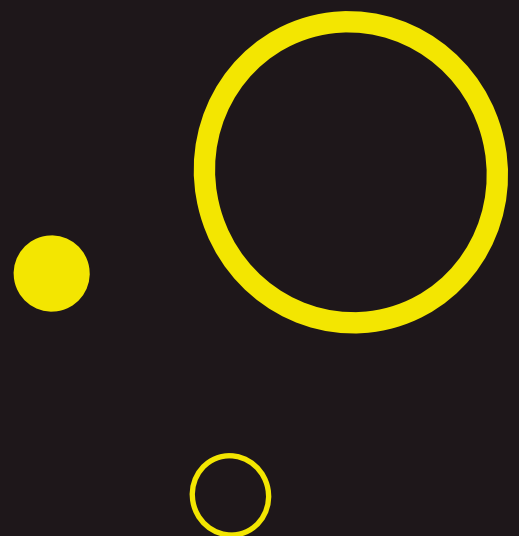


8.0 PROPOSED PARTNERS

- Soronko Academy
- National Community Development Vocational and Technical Institute, Madina

9.0 CURRICULAR DESIGN

The curricular for this pilot phase of the project will be design based on the Ghana National TVET curriculum. The curriculum will be modified to suit the duration of the skills training.



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